



MyGurukul

SACRED WISDOM — SATURDAY, FEBRUARY 14, 2026



SACRED TEXT

*etadeva paraṃ jñānametadeva paraṃ śivam |
etadeva paraṃ brahma etadeva paraṃ padam || 73 ||
vārāṇasīti bhuvanatrayasārabhūtā
ramyā purī mama sadā girirājaputri |
atrāgatā vividhaduṣkṛtakāriṇo 'pi
pāpakṣayādvirajasaḥ pratibhānti martyāḥ || 74 ||*

— Skandapurāṇa, Chapter 30, Verses 73-74

GURU'S INTERPRETATION

This powerful passage from the Skandapurāṇa reveals profound truths about knowledge, divinity, and the transformative power of Vārāṇasī. It declares that ultimate knowledge (paraṃ jñānam), ultimate auspiciousness (paraṃ śivam), ultimate reality (paraṃ brahma), and the ultimate state of being (paraṃ padam) are all one and the same. This emphasizes the interconnectedness of all things, suggesting that true understanding leads to liberation and unity with the divine. It's a reminder that the pursuit of knowledge isn't merely an intellectual exercise, but a spiritual journey toward realizing your own inherent divinity.

The verses then shift focus to Vārāṇasī, described as the very essence of the three worlds, a beautiful city eternally cherished. The text emphasizes the city's unique ability to purify even those burdened by the weight of their wrongdoings. It states that even those who arrive in Vārāṇasī having committed various sins find their negativity diminished, appearing pure and radiant. This isn't necessarily a literal absolution based on geographical location alone, but rather a metaphorical representation of the power of sacred spaces to catalyze inner transformation. Vārāṇasī acts as a powerful symbol for the possibility of renewal and redemption that exists within each of us, a chance to shed your burdens and emerge cleansed.

In modern life, this wisdom translates to understanding that true fulfillment comes from seeking knowledge that transcends the superficial. It encourages you to find your own "Vārāṇasī," whether it's a place, a practice, or a state of mind that allows you to confront your shadows, release negativity, and reconnect with your inner light. Just as the scripture speaks of purification, you too can actively work towards cleansing your thoughts, actions, and intentions, leading to a more virtuous and fulfilling life. The essence lies in the intention and effort to move towards self-improvement and spiritual understanding. It's about recognizing the potential for transformation within yourself and actively cultivating it.

REFLECTION FOR TODAY

What "Vārāṇasī" resides within your own life, offering you a space for profound healing and spiritual growth? How can you consciously cultivate this space to foster greater purity and radiance within yourself?